

RailCore

Growth Pathway Program

Manager & Employee Track

Creating Meaningful IDPs Through
Conversation, Action, and Follow-Up



Today's 2-Hour Application Workshop

Understand

IDP purpose, leader standard, shared journey

Analyze

Quality checklist, strong vs. weak IDPs

Practice

Fix a weak IDP and rehearse conversation language

Apply

Document in the system and draft your IDP component

Commit

Confirm follow-up rhythm and next step

Core message

Employees own their development. Managers support the conversation. Leaders reinforce the system.

Start with the Leader Standard

CONTEXT

The Leader Playbook defines what RailCore expects from IDP adoption.

- Meaningful development conversations, not just submitted forms
- Quality goals with practical actions and follow-up
- Shared ownership between employees, managers, leaders, and HR
- Consistency across regions with room for local application

Today: we put that standard into daily practice.



What You Will Be Able to Do

Explain IDP purpose and business connection

Identify what makes a strong IDP

Use a conversation model for IDP discussion

Draft one IDP goal, action, support request, and follow-up

Describe the shared journey and role responsibilities

Improve a weak or vague development goal

Document IDP actions in the system

Commit to one next step

01

Understand the IDP Journey

Purpose, role clarity, and how IDPs become a practical development process.



The 5-Step IDP Journey



The system documents the work, but the value comes from the conversation and follow-up.

Role Clarity: Who Owns What?

Employee

Reflects on goals, prepares for discussion, drafts IDP, takes action, updates progress.

Manager

Asks coaching questions, aligns goals, reviews quality, provides support, follows up.

Leader

Sets expectations, removes barriers, reviews adoption, reinforces meaningful follow-up.

HR / L&D

Provides process support, tools, job aids, reporting, and training reinforcement.

Shared ownership does not mean unclear ownership.

Quick Poll: Where Does the Process Get Hard?

POLL

Which IDP step is most difficult in real work?

Reflect • Discuss • Plan • Document • Follow Up

Use a show of hands, poll, or chat. The purpose is to surface risk before practice.

02

Analyze IDP Quality

Define what strong IDPs look like before asking people to create one.



IDP Quality Checklist

Goal Specific skill, behavior, capability, or career direction

Action Clear development activity or on-the-job practice

Timeline Milestone, target date, or review point

Follow-up Check-in rhythm and ownership

Connection Relevant to role, team needs, or future opportunity

Support Manager, resource, mentor, training, or exposure needed

Evidence How progress will be noticed or discussed

Strong vs. Weak IDP Example

Weak

“I want to improve communication skills.”

- Too broad
- No context
- No action
- No timeline
- No follow-up

Stronger

“By the end of Q2, I will improve shift handover communication by leading three structured handover briefings, using the team checklist, and asking for feedback during monthly check-ins.”

Specific • Work-connected • Observable • Time-bound • Followed up

Activity: Strong or Weak IDP Review

ACTIVITY

Review the two sample IDPs in your workbook.

- What makes the first example weak?
- What makes the second example stronger?
- Which checklist items are visible?
- What would you still improve?

Output

Participants can explain what “good” looks like before drafting their own IDP.

Format: pairs or table groups • Time: 8 minutes

03

Practice: Improve the Plan

Move from recognizing quality to making weak goals stronger.



Activity: Fix the Weak IDP

ACTIVITY

Choose one weak statement and revise it into a practical IDP component.

I want to become a better leader.

I want to improve technical skills.

I want to get promoted.

I want to communicate better.

I want to learn more about operations.

Use this structure:

- Development goal
- Why it matters
- Development action
- Support needed
- Timeline
- Follow-up checkpoint

Example: From Vague to Actionable

Before

“I want to communicate better.”



After

“Over the next eight weeks, I will improve communication during shift handovers by using the standard checklist, leading two handover briefings, and asking my manager and one peer for feedback before the next monthly check-in.”

Debrief: What checklist items are now included?

04

Practice: The IDP Conversation

A strong IDP is built through reflection, alignment, planning, and commitment.



Conversation Model: Reflect → Align → Plan → Commit

Reflect

Employee shares goals, strengths, gaps, interests. Manager asks open questions and listens.

Align

Connect goal to current role, team needs, or future opportunity.

Plan

Define development action, support, evidence, and timeline.

Commit

Agree on next step, ownership, and follow-up checkpoint.

Use this model to make the conversation focused, not scripted.

Question Bank for Better IDP Conversations

Reflect

1. What skill or capability do you want to develop next?
2. What feedback could guide your development?

Align

1. How does this goal connect to your role?
2. How could this support the team?

Plan

1. What action would help you practice this skill?
2. What support or resource would help?

Commit

1. What is the first step?
2. When should we check in?
3. How will we know progress is happening?

Micro-Practice: Improve the Conversation

PRACTICE

Scenario

Employee says: “I want to get promoted soon.”

- Managers: ask two coaching questions to clarify the goal.
- Employees: respond with more detail about role readiness and development needs.
- Switch roles if time allows.

Listen for

- Open-ended questions
- Connection to role/team needs
- More specific development action
- Clear next step

05

Apply: Document the IDP

The system makes goals, actions, support, and follow-up visible.



System Practice: What the CRM Supports

- Captures the outcome of the development conversation
- Makes goals, actions, support, and timelines visible
- Gives managers a place to review and provide feedback
- Supports follow-up before talent reviews

Reminder: the system supports the process; it does not replace the conversation.



Employee System Tasks

Employees practice entering and updating the IDP.

- Open the IDP form or system page
- Enter a development goal
- Add development actions
- Identify support needed
- Add timeline or target date
- Save / submit the IDP
- Update progress notes if applicable



Manager System Tasks

Managers practice reviewing and documenting support.

- Locate employee IDPs
- Review goals and development actions
- Add feedback or comments
- Return for revision if needed
- Confirm follow-up date
- Track progress or status



Guided Practice Scenario: Jordan Lee

SCENARIO

Employee: Jordan Lee | Role: Operations Coordinator

Goal:

Improve cross-functional communication during service disruption updates

Action:

Shadow one experienced coordinator, lead two update briefings, collect feedback from manager and dispatcher

Timeline:

Complete first milestone within 60 days | Follow-up: Monthly check-in

Use the scenario to complete the required system steps for your role.

06

Apply: Draft or Refine Your IDP

Turn learning into a clear goal, practical action, support request, and follow-up checkpoint.



Activity: Draft Your IDP Component

ACTIVITY

Complete one IDP component in your workbook:

My development goal

Why this goal matters

Development action I will take

Support or resources I need

Timeline or milestone

Evidence of progress

Follow-up checkpoint

Role-Based Application Options

Employees

Draft or refine your own IDP goal. Focus on ownership, action, support needed, and follow-up.

Managers

Option 1: Draft your own IDP goal as an employee of your leader.

Option 2: Review a sample employee IDP and prepare coaching feedback.

Recommended: managers draft their own goal first to model the behavior expected from others.

Peer / Manager Review

REVIEW

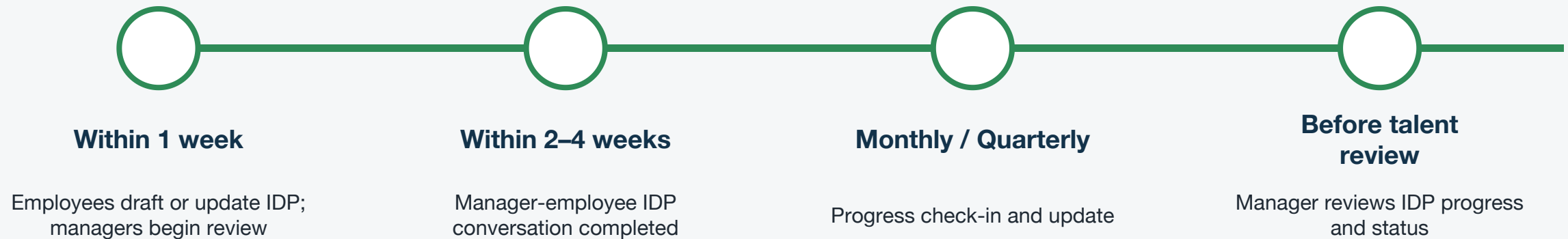
Give one strength and one improvement suggestion.

- Is the goal specific and clear?
- Is the action practical and connected to work?
- Is there a timeline and follow-up checkpoint?
- What question would help improve this goal?
- What support could the manager offer?

Feedback rule

Be practical. The purpose is to improve the IDP, not to judge the person.

Follow-Up: The Point Where IDPs Become Useful



An IDP is not complete when it is submitted. It becomes valuable when it is revisited.

How We Will Know This Worked

Fix the Weak IDP

Evidence: revised IDP example
Success: clearer goal, action, timeline, support, follow-up

System Practice

Evidence: completed sample entry or review
Success: required steps completed with limited support

IDP Draft Review

Evidence: draft IDP component
Success: meets most quality checklist criteria

Embedded assessment: practical performance, not a formal test.

My Next Step

What will you do next to make the IDP useful?

Complete one sentence in your workbook before you leave.

As an employee / manager, my next IDP action is: _____

Thank You

Creating meaningful IDPs through conversation, action, and follow-up.

- Finalize or submit your IDP
- Schedule the manager-employee conversation
- Use the quality checklist and conversation guide
- Revisit progress regularly

Stronger Teams. Safer Tracks. Better Journeys.

